League Rules as of November 27, 2012

A. SCORE SHEETS

1. **Completed score sheets are due no later than Friday close of business – the sooner the better.**
    a. **First time late turning in score sheet results in warning**
    b. **Second time late turning in score sheet results in 1 point deducted from standings**
    c. **Each successive time turning in score sheet late will result in a point being deducted for each time paperwork has been turned in late minus the warning.**
2. **During each match you may mark the winner with either a "W" or an "8" – the "8" represents the shooter made his 7 balls plus the 8-ball.**
3. **The WINNER of each game earns 8 points no matter how they win**
4. **The loser of each game earns 7 minus the number of balls left on the table from his group.**
5. **If you scratch on the 8 ball while legally attempting to pocket the 8 ball you have earned 7 points for that loss. Your opponent earns 8 points.**
6. **If you knock the 8 ball in early, you receive 7 minus the number of your balls left on the table; count any balls that were pocketed on that shot as balls made. The winner of this match earns 8 points.**
7. **No-Shows / Forfeits**
    a. **Offending team**
        i. **-1 point for the offending team for that match**
        ii. **Write in the player who would have shot that match - if he/she is not already on your roster they will be added to one of your open slots permanently**
    b. **Non-Offending team**
        i. **+1 point for the non-offending team for that match**
        ii. **Write in the player who was present and would have shot that match**
    c. **The match win/loss will not count toward individual statistics**
    d. **Both teams are responsible to turn in $25.00 for the night (see B.1)**
    e. **If both teams are short players for a match both teams score -1 point for that match.**

B. MONEY COLLECTION

1. **Each team will turn in $25.00 per night.**
2. **Teams are responsible for any money short of $25.00 in the event they are unable to field 5 shooters for the match.**

C. PAYOUTS

1. **$5.00 will be awarded to players who make the 8-ball on the break.**
2. **The number of teams paid out will be determined after the 5th week has been completed – this is in case we have a team, or teams, dropout.**
3. **The amount of money paid to each of those places will be announced midway through the season but this will only be an approximation of the real payouts.**

D. HANDICAPS

1. **There will be a max team-handicap for each week.**
2. **New players**
   - **a. If both captains can agree on a new players rating then shoot them at that rating**
   - **b. If not, it is a race to 3 for both players for that match**
     - **i. female shooters start out as a 3 towards the team handicap limit;**
     - **ii. male shooters count as a 4 towards the team handicap limit.**

E. EQUIPMENT

1. **Any regulation cue-stick above 40" is legal – you may not shoot with only a shaft if using a two-piece cue (remember, breaking the cue down is automatic forfeit).**
2. **Jump, and Jump-Break, cues are legal.**
3. **Breaking your shooting cue down during a game is loss of game.**

ALL FOULS ARE BALL-IN-HAND

F. TIMEOUTS

1. **Shooters rated 4, 3, 2, and 1 get timeouts per game and shooters rated 5, 6, 7, and 8 only can take one timeout per game.**
   - **a. Anyone on the team can call a timeout.**
   - **b. Discussing a rule - The shooter should call get the attention of both captains before discussing a rule to avoid disputes. Players are allowed to inquire about rules without using a timeout.**
   - **c. Timeouts will last about 1 minute from when the opposing team initially begins discussing the shot at hand.**
   - **d. If a timeout is taking longer than 1 minute, the non-shooting player may announce that his opponent is now "on the clock".**
   - **e. You have one additional minute if placed "on the clock".**
     - **i. Must give a 10-second warning to shooter who is "on the clock" when he has only 10 seconds left in clocked-minute.**
   - **f. Failure to break-up the timeout after additional "clocked" minute expires is a FOUL if the opposing team wants to enforce the rule.**
   - **g. This rule SHALL NOT BE ABUSED – You may enforce this rule strictly as it is a rule but please keep in mind this rule was put in place as a defense for those who are routinely abusing the length of their timeouts.**
   - **h. *While in timeout, only one person (the coach) may approach the shooter and discuss the current shot with that shooter. The coach may go back to discuss the shot with the other players on the team but ONLY the coach may directly talk to the shooter and give direct advice to the shooter.**
   - **i. *The coach must talk to the shooter at the table and the rest of the team must not communicate with the shooter from their positions.**

     *****The opposing team will initially warn the offending team of violations with respect to the rules marked with an asterisk above. Successive warnings may result in further warnings by the opposing team but the opposing team may call a foul if they desire to do so.**
2. **<u>DO NOT</u> touch any balls or mark the table while coaching – ALL violations will result in a FOUL.**

G. GAME PLAY

1. **Shooters rated 3, 2, or 1 DO NOT have to call any pockets except for when they are shooting the 8-ball.**
2. **4s and up must call a pocket (call pocket only – do not have to call banks, kisses, caroms, etc.).**
3. **Anyone can inform the shooter that a foul has occurred and that the shooter has ball-in-hand.**
4. **Jumping / masse shots are ALLOWED.**
5. **Touching any ball (other than cue ball) with hand, stick, or clothes <u>while shooter has ball-in-hand</u>: There is NO FOUL if it is the first time this has occurred during the MATCH. The shooter must indicate to his opponent that he has moved/touched a ball. The opponent then has the option to restore the balls to where they were or let the table lay as is.**
   a. **If the shooter does not indicate he has touched the balls and continues to shoot his opponent may issue a warning anyway.**
   b. **Subsequent violations result in a FOUL and the incoming shooter will play the table as it lays (do not restore balls to their previous positions).**

6. **Touching any ball (other than cue ball) with hand, stick, or clothes while shooter does not have ball in hand; the shooter must indicate to the opponent he has touched a ball, or balls, and his opponent has the option to restore the balls to where they previously laid or let the table lay as it is. If the shooter continues to shoot without indicating that he has touched or has moved a ball then the shooter has committed a FOUL.**
7. **Pushing through the cue ball IS ALLOWED at all times. Pushing through occurs when the cue ball is frozen or so close to the object ball that it would be impossible for the shooter to shoot the shot without double-hitting the cue ball.**
8. **If a shooter touches any ball while he has ball-in-hand it is a FOUL.**
9. **It is a FOUL if a cue ball is jumped into the air and touches an object OTHER THAN**
   a. **a ball of the shooter's group of balls (laying on the playing surface)**
   b. **a cushion,**
   c. **or the top of a cushion's rail**
   d. **In other words if the cue ball would touch a light, a light's chain, a cue's shaft, a piece of chalk, a player, etc..**
10. **While shooting the 8-ball the following is a loss of game**
    a. **A scratch**
    b. **Jumping cue ball off the table and onto another surface other than the table cloth you are playing on, the rails on the table you are playing on, or the top of the rail on the table you are playing on. It is not a FOUL if the cue ball leaves the table and rolls onto or lands on the top of a cushion's rail and then returns back to the table without touching any other objects such as hands, cues, chalk, clothing, etc.**
11. **It is a FOUL to jump balls off the table.**
    a. **8-ball jumped off table is a loss of game.**
    b. **Other balls jumped off the table GET POCKETED.**
12. **It is not the offending player's responsibility to declare he has fouled. It is the responsibility of his opponent to call the foul.**
13. **Shots that may potentially cause disputes;**
    a. **If a shot is attempted that may potentially cause a dispute PLEASE have both captains watch the shot.**
    b. **All frozen balls must be declared frozen by the shooter's opponent before the shooter shoots his next shot.**

c. **If a shot occurs where it was too close to tell which group of balls the cue ball made contact with first – the shooter gets the benefit of the doubt.**

14. **DO NOT TOUCH the cue ball until your opponent acknowledges he has fouled. All disputes will be settled by both team captains. If agreement cannot be reached a coin-flip will determine the outcome.**
15. **If you have ball-in-hand, you may move the cue ball around with ANY part of your cue, including the tip, ferrule, shaft, or butt AS LONG as you are not making any intent at stroking the cue ball. If you make any STROKE on the cue ball a shot has occurred.**
16. **Moving ball FOULS are:**
    a. **Touching the cue ball if it is still spinning.**
    b. **Shooting the cue ball if it is still spinning.**
    c. **Touching the cue ball if other balls are still moving.**
    d. **Touching an object ball if the cue ball is still moving.**
    e. **Touching an object ball if other object balls are still moving.**
17. **Racking**
    a. **Opponent racks**
    b. **8-ball must be the middle ball in third row back from head-ball.**
    c. **Rack placed on spot or as close as possible if cloth does not allow for a good rack when head ball is placed on spot.**
18. **Breaks**
    a. **Lag or flip coin to decide the first game's break.**
    b. **The winner of the previous game will break the next rack.**
    c. **Each player is afforded 1 miscue per match on the break. All successive miscues in same match will be loss of break attempt (opponent has option to defer the break back to the offending shooter).**
    d. **There are no illegal breaks in this league – play rack as it lays.**
    e. **Making the 8-ball on the break is a WIN.**
    f. **Making the 8-ball on the break and scratching is a LOSS.**
19. **Shot immediately following the break shot;**
    a. **IF STARTING OUT ON A FOULED TABLE**
        i. **Table is still open.**
        ii. **Incoming player has ball-in-hand behind the line.**
        iii. **Must make contact with a rail or ball in front of the line before any balls behind the line are contacted.**
        iv. **Balls jumped off the table on break IS A FOUL**
            a. **Ball-in-hand behind the line for opponent**
            b. **Play table as it lays (do not spot balls)**
            c. **ALL BALLS JUMPED OFF TABLE <u>ON BREAK</u> GET POCKETED.**
    b. **IF STARTING OUT ON A SUCCESFULLY BROKEN TABLE**
        i. **Table is still open following the break**
        ii. **May legally**
            a. **shoot a stripe into a solid.**
            b. **shoot a solid into a stripe.**
            c. **Shooters MAY NOT strike the 8-ball first with cue ball to pocket balls.**
        iii. **Table remains open until one player legally pockets a ball.**
        iv. **2s & 3s do not have to call ANYTHING to claim a group of balls.**

v. **If a 2 or 3 makes one ball from each group on the FIRST shot following the break shot (not their first shot at the table but the first shot immediately following the break) the table <u>IS STILL</u> open.**

H. STANDARD FOULS (not all-inclusive)

1. **Cue ball scratch or cue ball off of the legal playing surface.**
2. **Hit wrong ball first – the first ball contacted by the cue ball on each shot when the table is not "open" must belong to the shooter's group.**
3. **A ball does not travel to rail after contact on shots where no ball is pocketed**
   a. **If object ball is frozen initially it must travel to a rail other than the rail it is frozen to for it to be considered to have contacted another rail.**
   b. **The table has four rails – the long rails ARE NOT separate rails on each side of the side pocket; it is still the same rail.**
4. **Not having at least one foot on the floor**
5. **Ball driven off table**
6. **Touched cue ball when a player does not have ball-in-hand**
7. **Double-hitting the cue ball (however pushing is allowed)**
8. **Touching cue ball while it's in the air with any object or body part**
9. **Touching the cue ball while balls are still in motion**
10. **Touching balls with cue ball when you have ball-in-hand (1 warning per match)**
11. **Playing out of turn**

I. DOCUMENTS

1. **All documents can be found on <u>www.oc8ball.com</u>**
2. **You may request a copy of any document**
   a. **Email**
   b. **Phone**
   c. **Note: place request inside of paperwork envelope**

J. MISCELLANEOUS RULES

1. **Items not addressed by using these rules will be resolved by the team captains until the league can address the issue and put a rule into effect.**

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